RITUAL FOUNDATIONS

Sacred Geometry & Spiritual Order

Simple shapes for attention, boundaries, and meaningful practice

SHRINE OF THE INNER THRONE

Adorn the seat of your soul.

CHAMBER 01

Begin with a Shape

A pencil and paper can become a place to gather your attention.

Context Matters

Sacred geometry brings questions of shape, proportion, and pattern into spiritual life. Specific symbols belong to particular histories. A circle on a page is not automatically the same as a ritual sign from a living religious tradition.

Kongo cosmograms provide an important African context for studying spiritual form. The Metropolitan Museum of Art describes the dikenga as a diagram associated with the sun's movement and life's passage through birth, death, the spiritual realm, and rebirth (Source 1). This introduction does not claim to initiate readers into that system.

The meanings and drawing exercises that follow are the Shrine's teaching framework. They help organize personal practice; they are not universal ancient laws or guaranteed protective seals.

CHAMBER 02

Shape and Use

Choose a form you can explain.

A Shrine Reference

- Circle | Use: wholeness, continuity, personal boundary. Example: write a household blessing inside a circle.
- Square | Use: stability, structure, grounded responsibility. Example: label four sides Body, Home, Work, and Spirit.
- Triangle | Use: focus, direction, bringing three parts together. Example: label its points Purpose, Action, and Support.
- Spiral | Use: returning, gradual development, revisiting a lesson. Example: mark stages of a project along a drawn spiral.
- Intersecting lines | Use: meeting, decision, relationship. Example: map two responsibilities and write what they need at the intersection.
- Grid | Use: order, balance, distributing attention. Example: place four written priorities in four paper squares.

Cultural Specificity

The diagram of intersecting lines in our exercise is not a Kongo cosmogram. Avoid relabeling a veve, yantra, or other tradition's sacred form as your own invented symbol. Study its people, purpose, and context before adopting a practice.

CHAMBER 03

Make Space for the Work

Let the arrangement make the purpose easier to see.

Three Simple Applications

- Protection: draw a circle around a written boundary, such as 'My home welcomes respect.' Pair it with an action that supports that boundary.
- Prosperity: draw a square with four areas: Earning, Spending, Saving, and Sharing. Add one realistic action in each.
- Power: draw a triangle labeled Voice, Skill, and Support. Write the next step that strengthens each point.

Materials and Placement

Use a notebook, card, washable drawing board, or digital page. Keep the form temporary unless you own and may alter the surface. A diagram does not need crystals, powders, permanent floor markings, or a candle.

You may use your own colors to distinguish parts. Write down what each means. A consistent personal system is more useful than a complicated pattern you cannot explain.

CHAMBER 04

The Inner Throne Map

An original Shrine practice for choosing a starting point.

Draw and Reflect

1. Draw a circle in the middle of a page. Write your name inside it.
2. Draw a square around the circle. Label the sides with four areas of life that matter to you.
3. Outside each side, write one thing that area needs: rest, order, money, support, or a clearer boundary.
4. Draw a line from the center toward the need that feels most important now.
5. At the end of the line, write one step you can take this week. Add who or what could help.
6. Sit with the page for a few minutes. Simplify anything that distracts from the purpose.
7. Date the map and return after a week. Note the action taken and what you learned.

I know my center. I make room for what matters. I choose a step I can sustain.

CHAMBER 05

Return to the Pattern

Repetition can help you notice what is changing.

Keep a Small Record

- What did drawing make clearer?
- Did the shape help me act or only keep me planning?
- Which meaning is personal, and which comes from a source I should study?

A Note on Claims

Meaningful patterns do not prove scientific claims about healing frequencies, energy fields, or inevitable results. Here, the drawing serves prayer, reflection, and deliberate action.

Sources and Further Study

- 1. The Metropolitan Museum of Art, Kongo crucifix: dikenga context.
- 2. The Metropolitan Museum of Art, Crucifix: Four Moments of the Sun.
- Robert Farris Thompson, Flash of the Spirit. Further reading on African and African American visual and spiritual traditions.

Closing

Let the form help you see. Let the next step give the pattern life.